

PROCESS

The project began with research into the cultural and visual resurgence of hyper-feminine aesthetics. Drawing from fashion collections, trend forecasting, historical references, and social shifts, I investigated why these visual codes are reappearing today. Rather than viewing the trend as purely nostalgic, the research considered the tension between traditional ideas of femininity and the contemporary desire to reclaim these aesthetics as forms of personal expression. The resulting design direction centred around recurring colours, materials, and details such as bright pinks, satin, lace, bows, pearls, and beading.

To translate this research into a physical outcome, I customised a series of second-hand shoes sourced through Poelman Brands. Repurposing footwear that would otherwise have been discarded connected the project to broader themes of sustainability and circular design. Each shoe was developed intuitively, combining carefully selected trend elements while responding to the original construction of the footwear. Rather than treating every pair identically, each design explored a different expression of the FemmeWave aesthetic.

The four strongest outcomes were presented through an editorial photoshoot, with each shoe placed within its own distinct visual world. Instead of functioning as product photography alone, the images extended the design direction into narrative environments, demonstrating how trend research can be translated into both object and atmosphere.